MGT 409 · AI FOUNDATIONS FOR MANAGERS

# RUNWAY

**how long will my money last?**

A student photographs a statement. Code, not the model, says how the month compares with what is left after rent.

Pink Pawika · October 26, 2026

## THE PROBLEM

# After rent, how far does the living allowance go?

Who

An international student whose I-20 already states a yearly living figure. Rent takes a known share of it.

Today

They type a photo into a spreadsheet, Copilot, or Monarch. A chatbot can read one file, then the answer stays in the chat.

Cost

Entering one statement by hand takes about 30 minutes. A bad minus sign is hard to spot later.

The miss

Bank apps list charges. They do not answer what is left after rent.

**WHAT IS NEW**

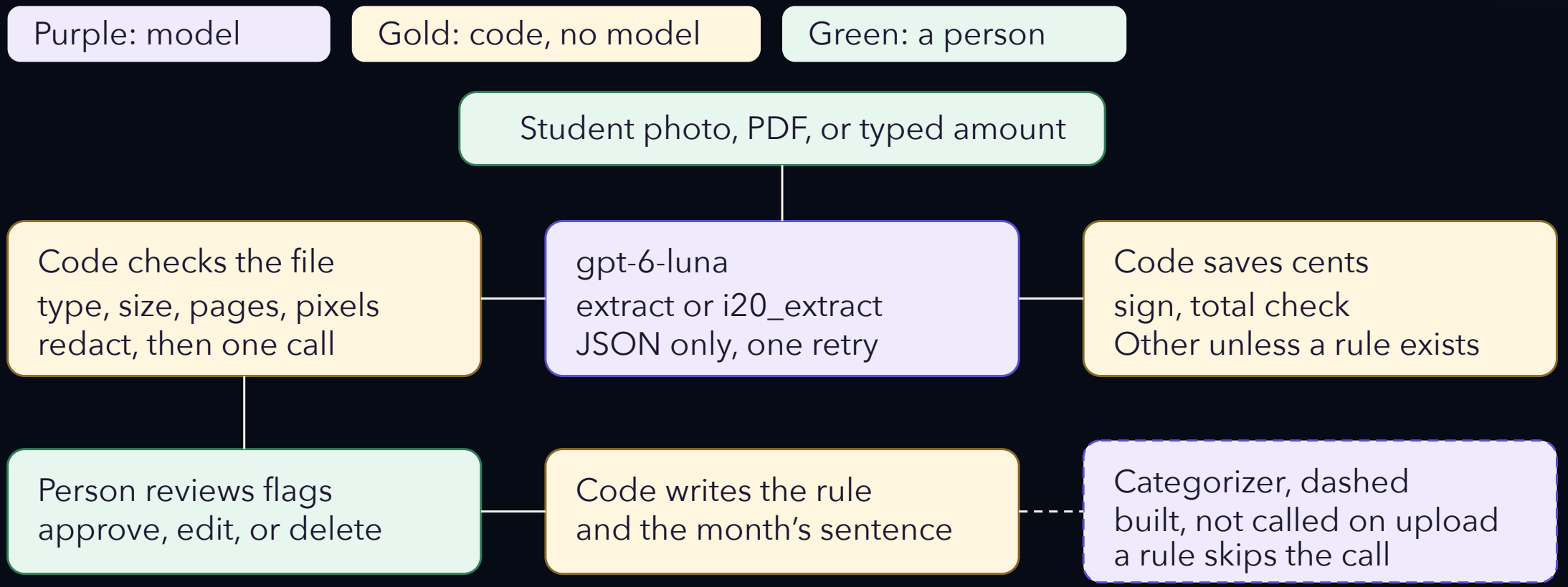
# Built for one living allowance, not a bank feed.

Mint, Copilot Money, Monarch Money, Expensify, and ChatGPT with a file upload already exist. They stop before this ledger.

- The model only reads. Code does the math, in integer cents.
- A receipt with a total is one store row. A statement is one row per line. Balances are not purchases.
- Green amounts are money received and are left out of the list.
- If a printed total does not match the lines, every line waits in review.
- The I-20 path uses yearly living expenses only. Nothing is saved until rent is saved.

## HOW THE AGENTS WORK

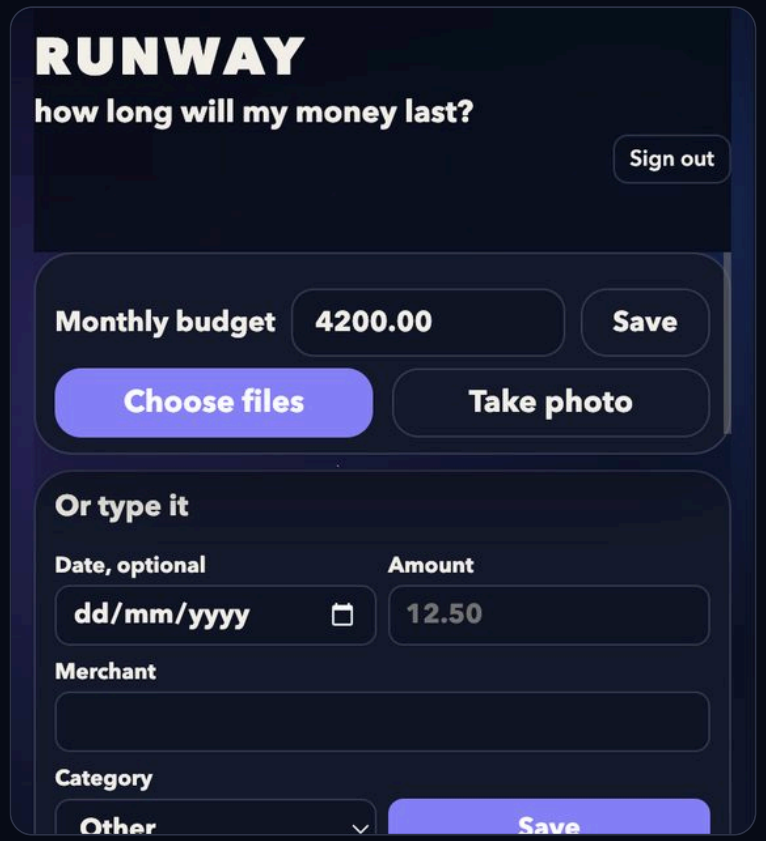
# A pipeline. The model has no tools of its own.



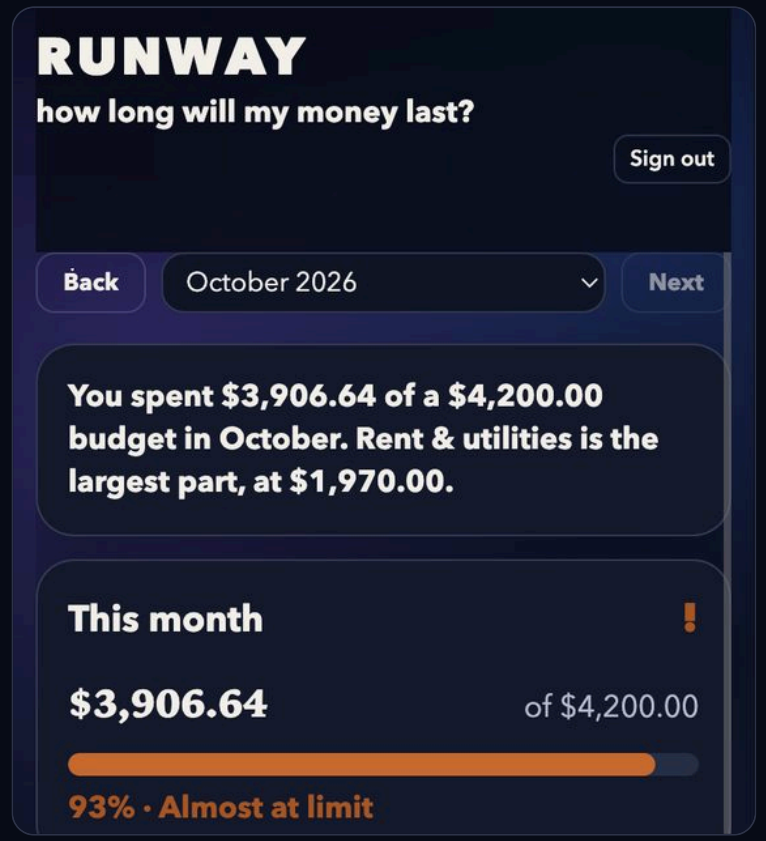

I-20: the model may read the yearly number. Code divides by 9 or 12 and saves only when rent is saved. Analytics and the projection never call the model.

DEMO

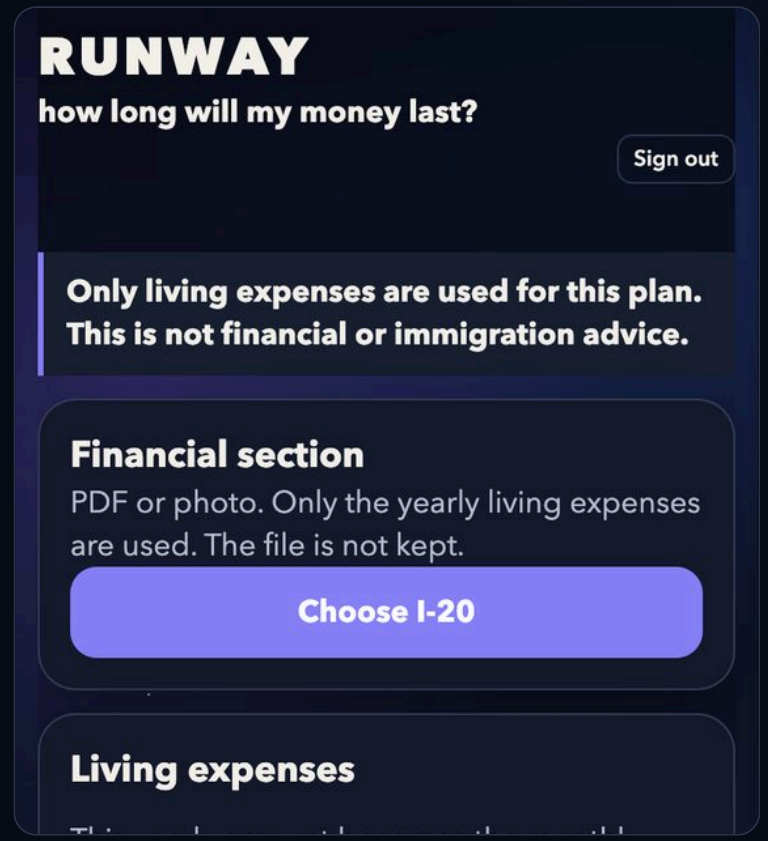
# October, from the running app.




Activity. Type it, or upload a photo.




Analytics. The month is one sentence.




I-20. Living expenses only. Not advice.

COST

# One photo read averages $0.000708.

Lecture prices for gpt-6-luna. Measured on the second pass, not estimated. Cached tokens are billed once, at the cheaper rate.

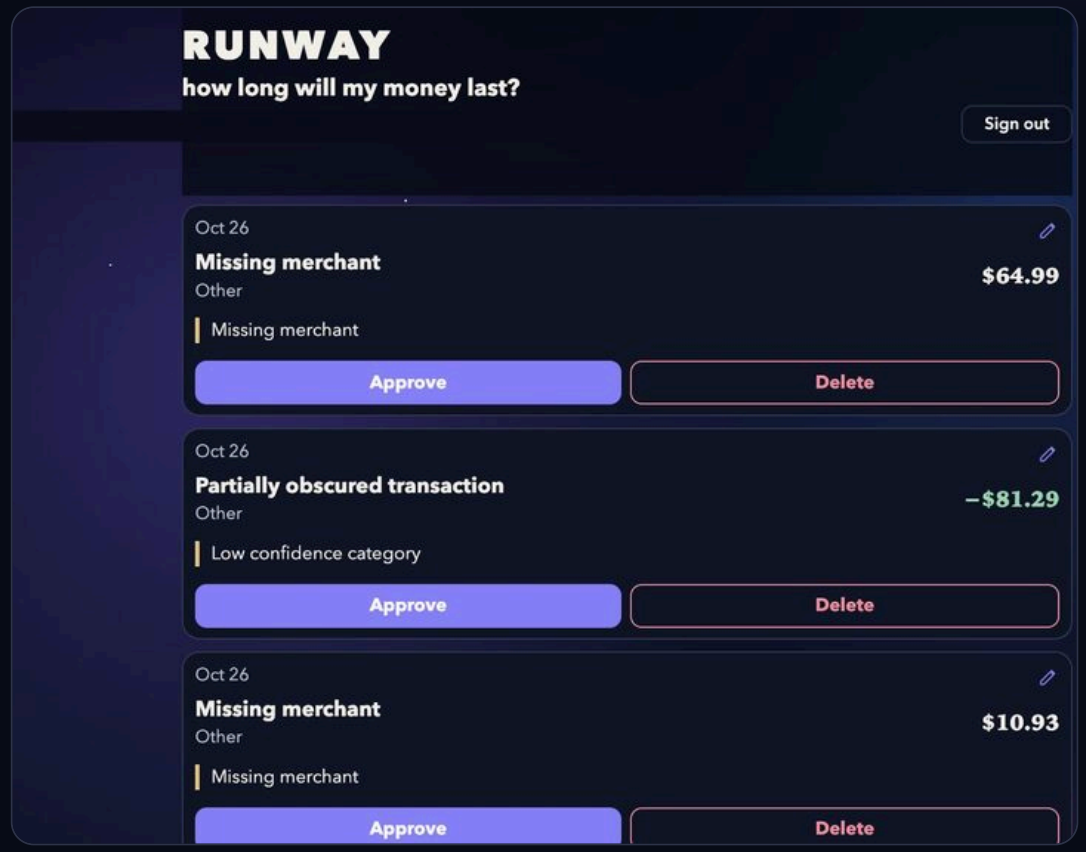
| CASE | 1 USER | 100 | 10,000 |
|---|---|---|---|
| This account, once | $0.012796 | $1.28 | $127.96 |
| Later month, assumed 4 photo reads | $0.002833 | $0.28 | $28.33 |
| Cap, 40 average reads a day for 30 days | $0.85 | $84.98 | $8,498.25 |

Leaving the categorizer off upload did hurt: 102 of 110 rows are still Other. One measured categorize call was $0.000072. After a rule, the same names cost $0.

**SAFETY**

# A document can be read. It cannot give orders.

- Untrusted text is prefaced and redacted before the model sees it.
- The extract schema has no category, so a file cannot set Income.
- A hostile $4.50 sample stays 450 cents, category Other, status review.
- The live gateway blocked that file. The proof is the unit test.
- The day stops at 40 runs. A retry is the same run, not a second one.




First pass: uncertain rows waited here instead of being filed.

**IMPACT**

# One real user. One October.

**$3,906.64**

of a $4,200 budget · 93% · $293.36 under

Besides rent

$1,936.64 of purchases. Rent of $1,970 is still inside the spent total.

From photos

110 rows, 18 successful reads, $0.012796. None are waiting in review.

Left out

15 received rows, the green amounts, are not in that spent number.

Time

Hand entry is about 30 minutes a statement. I did not time a measured saving.

## WHAT'S NEXT

# Close these first.

| # | STEP | DONE WHEN |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Categorize once per batch, only names with no rule | Other falls below 20% of rows |
| 2 | Split rent from leftover spending | October shows $1,936.64 against the budget |
| 3 | Send every row under 0.70 confidence to review | None of those rows sit outside review |
| 4 | Stop painting rent onto empty months | The trend shows only months with purchases |
| 5 | A hostile file the gateway will accept | A screenshot of review catching it |
| 6 | Time a second person loading one month | A measured time against the 30-minute baseline |